



JOYBRINGERS

Helping young people Believe, Belong, and Become

Registered Charity Number 1212606

JOYBRINGERS CHARITY SAFEGUARDING POLICY

Protecting Children, Young People and Adults at Risk

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1. Policy Statement

Joybringers Charity is committed to creating a safe, welcoming and inclusive environment where children, young people and adults at risk are protected from harm and treated with dignity and respect. Safeguarding is everyone's responsibility. Every trustee, employee, volunteer and anyone acting on behalf of Joybringers Charity has a duty to promote the welfare of those we support and to take appropriate action if they have concerns about someone's safety or wellbeing.

We believe that every child, young person and adult at risk has the right to:

- Be safe and protected from abuse, neglect and exploitation.
- Be listened to and taken seriously.
- Be treated with dignity, fairness and respect.
- Be supported to achieve their full potential.
- Participate in our activities in an environment that promotes equality, inclusion and wellbeing.

Joybringers Charity has a zero-tolerance approach to abuse, neglect, exploitation, bullying, discrimination and any behaviour that places children, young people or adults at risk of harm.

We are committed to:

- Promoting the welfare of all children, young people and adults at risk.
- Providing safe services, activities and environments.
- Recruiting and supporting suitable staff and volunteers through safer recruitment practices.
- Providing safeguarding training appropriate to each role.
- Responding promptly and appropriately to safeguarding concerns.
- Working in partnership with parents, carers, local authorities, schools, statutory agencies and other organisations to safeguard those we support.
- Reviewing this policy annually to ensure it reflects current legislation, Charity Commission guidance and best practice.

Safeguarding is embedded in every aspect of our work and is fundamental to delivering our charitable objectives responsibly and effectively.



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2. About Joybringers Charity

Who We Are

Joybringers Charity is a registered charity (Charity No. **1212606**) based in Newcastle upon Tyne. We exist to support children, young people and families by creating opportunities that improve confidence, wellbeing, education, employability and community participation.

We believe that every child and young person should have the opportunity to **believe in themselves, belong in their community and become the best version of themselves**, regardless of their background or circumstances.

Our work focuses particularly on supporting people facing disadvantage, including those from low-income households, ethnic minority communities, refugees, asylum seekers, young carers, unemployed young people and others who may experience barriers to reaching their full potential.

What We Do

Joybringers Charity delivers a range of programmes and community activities throughout the year, including:

- Youth mentoring and personal development
- Digital skills and employability programmes
- Coding and data analytics training
- Career guidance, CV writing and interview preparation
- Parent and family engagement activities
- Community food bank and cost-of-living support
- Holiday activities and educational trips
- Community events and celebrations
- Volunteer development and leadership opportunities
- Partnership projects with schools, businesses and community organisations

Our services are delivered through a combination of group sessions, workshops, one-to-one mentoring, outreach activities and community events.

Who We Support

Our primary beneficiaries are:

- Children and young people aged **7–25**
- Parents and carers
- Families experiencing financial hardship
- Adults at risk where appropriate
- Volunteers supporting our charitable activities

Some activities are designed specifically for children or young people, while others involve families and members of the wider community.



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Our Commitment to Safeguarding

Because our work brings us into regular contact with children, young people and adults at risk, safeguarding is central to everything we do.

We recognise that everyone has the right to feel safe when taking part in our activities. We are committed to creating an environment where concerns are taken seriously, risks are managed appropriately and everyone is treated with dignity, fairness and respect.

Safeguarding is embedded within our governance, recruitment, programme delivery, volunteer management and partnerships.

3. Purpose and Scope

Purpose

The purpose of this Safeguarding Policy is to ensure that Joybringers Charity fulfils its duty to safeguard and promote the welfare of children, young people and adults at risk who engage with our activities.

This policy provides a clear framework for preventing harm, recognising safeguarding concerns, responding appropriately to concerns and working with statutory agencies where necessary.

It also sets out the responsibilities of everyone representing Joybringers Charity in maintaining a safe environment.

Scope

This policy applies to everyone working for or on behalf of Joybringers Charity, including:

- Trustees
- Employees
- Volunteers
- Sessional workers
- Freelance tutors
- Contractors
- Students on placement
- Partner organisations delivering activities on our behalf
- Anyone representing Joybringers Charity in an official capacity

The policy applies to all activities organised or delivered by Joybringers Charity, including:

- Activities at our offices
- Community venues
- Schools and colleges
- Parks and outdoor events
- Educational visits
- Holiday activities



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- Online training
- Virtual meetings
- Social media interactions connected with our programmes

It applies whether activities take place during normal working hours, evenings, weekends or holidays. Every individual working with Joybringers Charity is expected to understand and comply with this policy.

4. Our Safeguarding Commitment

Joybringers Charity is committed to creating a culture where safeguarding is everyone's responsibility. We will:

- Put the welfare of children, young people and adults at risk first.
- Listen carefully to concerns and take them seriously.
- Promote equality, diversity and inclusion.
- Encourage individuals to speak up if something does not feel right.
- Ensure all concerns are responded to promptly and appropriately.
- Maintain safer recruitment practices.
- Provide regular safeguarding training.
- Work openly with parents, carers and statutory agencies.
- Continually review our safeguarding arrangements to ensure they remain effective.

We recognise that safeguarding is not simply about responding to incidents. It is about preventing harm, promoting wellbeing and creating environments where people feel safe, valued and respected.

4. Legal and Regulatory Framework

Joybringers Charity is committed to complying with all relevant safeguarding legislation and guidance applicable in England.

This Safeguarding Policy has been developed in accordance with current legislation, statutory guidance and recognised best practice, including but not limited to:

Primary Legislation

- Children Act 1989
- Children Act 2004
- Care Act 2014
- Safeguarding Vulnerable Groups Act 2006
- Equality Act 2010
- Human Rights Act 1998
- Protection of Freedoms Act 2012
- Modern Slavery Act 2015
- Counter-Terrorism and Security Act 2015 (Prevent Duty)
- Data Protection Act 2018



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- UK General Data Protection Regulation (UK GDPR)
- Online Safety Act 2023

Statutory Guidance

Joybringers Charity has regard to the following Government guidance:

- **Working Together to Safeguard Children (2023)**
- **Keeping Children Safe in Education (current edition)** (where relevant)
- **Care and Support Statutory Guidance (Care Act 2014)**
- **Prevent Duty Guidance**
- **Information Sharing Advice for Safeguarding Practitioners**

Charity Commission Guidance

This policy also reflects guidance issued by the Charity Commission for England and Wales, including:

- Safeguarding and protecting people for charities and trustees
- The Essential Trustee (CC3)
- Serious Incident Reporting Guidance

Where legislation or statutory guidance changes, Joybringers Charity will review and update this policy accordingly.

5. Key Definitions

For the purposes of this policy, the following definitions apply.

Safeguarding

Safeguarding means protecting children, young people and adults at risk from abuse, neglect, exploitation and harm while promoting their health, wellbeing, rights and opportunities to live safely. Safeguarding includes preventing harm before it occurs and responding appropriately whenever concerns arise.

Child

A child is anyone under the age of **18 years**, regardless of their circumstances or level of independence.

Young Person

Within Joybringers Charity, a young person generally refers to an individual aged **11–25 years** participating in our programmes.

For safeguarding purposes, anyone under the age of 18 is legally considered a child.

Adult at Risk

An adult at risk is someone aged **18 or over** who:

- has care and support needs; and
- is experiencing, or is at risk of, abuse or neglect; and



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- is unable to protect themselves because of those needs.

This definition follows the Care Act 2014.

Abuse

Abuse is any action or failure to act that causes harm or places another person at risk of harm.

Abuse may be:

- a single incident;
- repeated behaviour;
- intentional or unintentional;
- committed by adults, children or young people.

Neglect

Neglect is the ongoing failure to meet a person's basic physical or emotional needs, resulting in actual or potential harm.

Harm

Harm means ill-treatment or impairment of health or development, including emotional wellbeing.

Disclosure

A disclosure occurs when a child, young person or adult at risk tells someone that they are experiencing abuse or neglect.

Disclosures may be:

- direct;
- indirect;
- accidental;
- verbal;
- written;
- online.

Every disclosure must be taken seriously.

Safeguarding Concern

A safeguarding concern is any information, observation or allegation suggesting that a child, young person or adult at risk may be experiencing abuse, neglect or exploitation.

A concern does **not** require proof.

If someone is worried, they should report it.



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Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL)

The Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL) is the person appointed by Joybringers Charity to take overall responsibility for safeguarding matters.

The DSL will:

- receive safeguarding concerns;
- maintain safeguarding records;
- liaise with statutory agencies;
- advise staff and volunteers;
- oversee safeguarding training.

6. Types of Abuse

Joybringers Charity recognises that abuse can occur in many forms.

Every trustee, employee and volunteer must understand the different types of abuse and know how to recognise them.

Physical Abuse

Physical abuse involves deliberately causing physical harm.

Examples include:

- hitting
- shaking
- burning
- poisoning
- suffocating
- inappropriate restraint
- throwing objects

Possible signs include:

- unexplained injuries
- repeated bruising
- burns
- fear of certain people
- flinching when approached

Emotional Abuse

Emotional abuse involves persistent behaviour that damages a person's emotional wellbeing or self-esteem.

Examples include:

- intimidation



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- humiliation
- constant criticism
- threats
- bullying
- controlling behaviour
- rejection

Possible signs include:

- low confidence
- anxiety
- withdrawal
- self-harm
- excessive fear of making mistakes

Sexual Abuse

Sexual abuse involves forcing or persuading someone to participate in sexual activity.

This includes:

- inappropriate touching
- grooming
- exploitation
- sharing sexual images
- online abuse
- sexual assault

Possible signs include:

- sexualised behaviour inappropriate for age
- fear of certain individuals
- unexplained injuries
- sudden behavioural changes

Neglect

Neglect is the persistent failure to meet a person's basic needs.

Examples include:

- inadequate food
- poor hygiene
- lack of medical care
- unsafe living conditions
- lack of supervision



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Possible signs include:

- poor appearance
- hunger
- untreated illness
- regular absence
- tiredness

Financial Abuse

Examples include:

- theft
- fraud
- misuse of benefits
- coercion regarding money
- exploitation of vulnerable adults

Domestic Abuse

Domestic abuse may involve:

- physical violence
- emotional abuse
- coercive control
- financial control
- psychological abuse

Children living in households affected by domestic abuse are also victims.

Discriminatory Abuse

Abuse motivated by prejudice relating to:

- race
- religion
- disability
- age
- sex
- sexual orientation
- gender identity

Joybringers Charity has zero tolerance for discrimination.



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Online Abuse

Online abuse includes:

- cyberbullying
- grooming
- coercion
- exploitation
- sharing inappropriate images
- online harassment
- impersonation

Because Joybringers delivers digital learning programmes, online safeguarding is an essential part of our safeguarding responsibilities.

Child Criminal Exploitation (CCE)

Children may be manipulated or coerced into criminal activity for another person's benefit.

Examples include:

- County Lines
- drug distribution
- theft
- carrying weapons

Child Sexual Exploitation (CSE)

CSE occurs when an individual or group exploits a child through sexual activity in exchange for something the child needs or believes they need.

Radicalisation

Radicalisation is the process by which a person comes to support extremist beliefs or terrorism.

Staff and volunteers should remain alert to signs that someone may be vulnerable to radicalisation and follow the Prevent Duty guidance where appropriate.

7. Recognising the Signs of Abuse and Neglect

Safeguarding concerns may arise from something a child, young person or adult at risk says, something someone observes, or a change in behaviour over time. Not all signs indicate abuse, but all concerns should be taken seriously and reported appropriately.



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Staff, volunteers and trustees should remain alert to changes in appearance, behaviour or circumstances that may indicate someone is at risk of harm.

Possible Indicators of Abuse

Physical Indicators

Examples include:

- Unexplained bruises, burns or injuries
- Injuries inconsistent with the explanation given
- Frequent accidents
- Untreated medical conditions
- Poor hygiene or inappropriate clothing
- Signs of malnutrition

Behavioural Indicators

Examples include:

- Sudden changes in behaviour
- Becoming withdrawn or unusually quiet
- Aggressive or challenging behaviour
- Fear of particular people or places
- Reluctance to go home
- Anxiety or depression
- Self-harm
- Running away
- Poor attendance or repeated lateness

Emotional Indicators

Examples include:

- Low self-esteem
- Excessive worrying
- Difficulty trusting adults
- Extreme mood swings
- Loss of confidence



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- Lack of concentration
 - Social isolation

Online Indicators

As Joybringers Charity delivers digital learning and online activities, staff and volunteers should remain alert to:

- Online grooming
- Cyberbullying
- Sextortion
- Sharing inappropriate images
- Contact with unknown adults online
- Radicalisation through online platforms
- Excessive secrecy about internet use

Adults at Risk

Possible indicators include:

- Unexplained injuries
- Poor living conditions
- Sudden financial difficulties
- Fearfulness
- Isolation
- Unexplained changes in behaviour
- Signs of neglect or exploitation

Remember

A safeguarding concern does **not** need to be proven.

If you **see something, hear something, or feel something is not right**, report it.

It is always better to report a concern than to ignore it.



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8. Our Safeguarding Principles

Everything Joybringers Charity does is guided by the following safeguarding principles.

We will always:

Put people first

The safety and wellbeing of children, young people and adults at risk will always come before organisational interests.

Listen

We will listen carefully to concerns without judgement and take all disclosures seriously.

Act promptly

Concerns will never be ignored.

Appropriate action will always be taken.

Work together

Safeguarding is everyone's responsibility.

We will work with:

- Parents
- Carers
- Schools
- Local Authorities
- Police
- Health professionals
- Partner organisations

where appropriate.



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Respect confidentiality

Information will only be shared with those who need to know in order to protect someone from harm.

Promote equality

Everyone has the right to participate safely regardless of:

- Age
- Disability
- Ethnicity
- Faith
- Gender
- Sexual orientation
- Gender identity
- Socio-economic background

Learn continuously

Safeguarding practice will be reviewed regularly to ensure continuous improvement.

9. Roles and Responsibilities

Safeguarding is everyone's responsibility.

However, different individuals have different responsibilities.

Board of Trustees

The Board of Trustees has overall responsibility for safeguarding within Joybringers Charity.

Trustees will:

- Promote a safeguarding culture throughout the charity.
- Approve and review safeguarding policies.
- Ensure appropriate safeguarding resources are available.
- Monitor safeguarding performance.



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-
- Ensure serious incidents are reported to the Charity Commission where required.
 - Ensure safeguarding risks are included within the charity's Risk Register.
 - Support the Designated Safeguarding Lead.

Chair of Trustees

The Chair will:

- Provide strategic safeguarding oversight.
- Ensure safeguarding is discussed at trustee meetings.
- Support safeguarding investigations where appropriate.
- Ensure the policy is reviewed annually.

Chief Executive Officer (CEO)

The CEO will:

- Promote safeguarding throughout the organisation.
- Ensure safeguarding procedures are implemented.
- Allocate appropriate resources.
- Ensure all staff receive training.
- Support the Designated Safeguarding Lead.
- Promote a safe organisational culture.

Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL)

Joybringers Charity will appoint a Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL).

The DSL is responsible for:

- Receiving safeguarding concerns.
- Keeping confidential safeguarding records.
- Providing safeguarding advice.
- Liaising with Children's Social Care and Adult Social Care.
- Liaising with the Police where necessary.
- Referring concerns to the Local Authority Designated Officer (LADO).
- Ensuring safeguarding training is completed.
- Monitoring safeguarding compliance.



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- Reporting safeguarding matters to trustees.

The DSL should undertake safeguarding training appropriate to their role and refresh this regularly.

Staff

Every employee must:

- Read and understand this policy.
- Complete safeguarding training.
- Follow the Code of Conduct.
- Report safeguarding concerns immediately.
- Maintain professional boundaries.
- Cooperate with investigations.

Volunteers

Volunteers play an essential role within Joybringers Charity.

Every volunteer must:

- Complete safeguarding induction.
- Follow this policy.
- Report concerns immediately.
- Maintain professional boundaries.
- Never investigate concerns themselves.

Tutors and Sessional Workers

Anyone delivering programmes must:

- Create safe learning environments.
- Supervise participants appropriately.
- Follow online safety guidance.
- Report safeguarding concerns.
- Maintain professional boundaries at all times.



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Parents and Carers

Parents and carers are important safeguarding partners.

Joybringers Charity will:

- Encourage open communication.
- Share safeguarding information where appropriate.
- Obtain consent where required.
- Respect confidentiality.
- Work collaboratively whenever possible.

Participants

Children and young people are encouraged to:

- Treat others respectfully.
- Report concerns.
- Speak to trusted adults.
- Follow programme rules.
- Help create a safe environment for everyone.

10. Designated Safeguarding Officers

The Board of Trustees appoints the following safeguarding officers.

Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL)

Name: Esele Okosun

Position: Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL)

Telephone: +44 7500 010317

Email: Esele.Okosun@joybringerscharity.org

Deputy Designated Safeguarding Lead

Name: John Porlycarp

Position: Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL)



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Telephone: +44 7500 010317

Email: john.porlycarp@joybringerscharity.org

The Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL) has overall responsibility for safeguarding within Joybringers Charity. In the absence of the DSL, the Deputy Designated Safeguarding Lead will assume these responsibilities. Both officers will receive appropriate safeguarding training and will act as the first point of contact for safeguarding concerns.

If neither person is available and someone is at immediate risk of harm, staff or volunteers must contact:

- Police – **999**
- Children's Social Care
- Adult Social Care

without delay.

11. Code of Conduct

Introduction

Everyone representing Joybringers Charity is expected to behave professionally and in a manner that promotes the safety, dignity and wellbeing of children, young people and adults at risk.

This Code of Conduct applies to:

- Trustees
- Employees
- Volunteers
- Freelance tutors
- Contractors
- Students on placement
- Anyone acting on behalf of Joybringers Charity

Failure to comply with this Code may result in disciplinary action, removal from volunteering, termination of contracts or referral to the appropriate statutory authorities.



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Expected Standards of Behaviour

Everyone working with Joybringers Charity must:

- Treat every individual with dignity, fairness and respect.
- Act honestly, professionally and with integrity.
- Promote equality, diversity and inclusion.
- Respect people's privacy.
- Maintain appropriate professional boundaries.
- Follow this Safeguarding Policy at all times.
- Challenge inappropriate behaviour where it is safe to do so.
- Report safeguarding concerns immediately.

Professional Boundaries

Staff and volunteers must always maintain professional relationships with beneficiaries.

They must not:

- Develop inappropriate personal relationships.
- Show favouritism.
- Spend unnecessary time alone with a child or vulnerable adult.
- Share personal problems with beneficiaries.
- Become financially involved with beneficiaries.
- Accept inappropriate gifts or favours.

One-to-One Working

Joybringers Charity recognises that one-to-one support may sometimes be necessary, particularly during mentoring or employability support.

Where this happens:

- Wherever possible, meetings should take place in an open environment.
- Doors should remain open or have clear visibility through glass panels.
- Parents or carers should be informed where appropriate.
- Another responsible adult should be nearby whenever possible.
- One-to-one sessions should be recorded in programme records.

No one-to-one meeting should take place in a private home.



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Physical Contact

Appropriate physical contact may sometimes be necessary, for example:

- Providing first aid.
- Preventing immediate injury.
- Comforting a distressed child in an appropriate manner.

Physical contact must always be:

- appropriate,
- proportionate,
- respectful,
- and in the best interests of the individual.

Staff and volunteers must never:

- initiate unnecessary physical contact,
- engage in rough play,
- use physical punishment,
- restrain someone unless necessary to prevent immediate harm.

Language and Behaviour

Everyone representing Joybringers Charity must use language that is:

- respectful,
- inclusive,
- age appropriate,
- encouraging.

The following are unacceptable:

- shouting,
- humiliation,
- sarcasm intended to belittle,
- discriminatory language,
- sexually inappropriate jokes,
- swearing directed at participants,
- intimidation.



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Photography and Video

Photographs and videos are important for celebrating achievements and promoting the work of Joybringers Charity.

However:

- Written consent must be obtained before photographs or videos are taken, where required.
- Images must only be used for authorised charity purposes.
- Images should never place a child or vulnerable adult at risk.
- Personal information must not be published alongside photographs without appropriate consent.
- Images must be stored securely.

Participants and parents have the right to refuse photography without affecting participation.

Social Media

Staff and volunteers must:

- use social media responsibly,
- protect confidential information,
- avoid inappropriate online interactions with beneficiaries,
- represent the charity professionally.

They must not:

- "friend" or follow children on personal social media accounts,
- send inappropriate private messages,
- post photographs without consent,
- discuss safeguarding matters online.

Where communication is necessary, official Joybringers Charity accounts or approved communication platforms should be used.

WhatsApp and Messaging Apps

Messaging applications may be used for programme communication where appropriate.

The following rules apply:



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- Group chats should be used wherever possible.
- Parents or carers should be included for children under 18 where appropriate.
- Messages should only relate to programme activities.
- Communication should take place during reasonable hours.
- Personal conversations should be avoided.
- Staff and volunteers should not use disappearing messages for charity business.

Transporting Children and Young People

Staff and volunteers should not normally transport children or young people in private vehicles.

Where transport is necessary:

- prior authorisation must be obtained,
- parental consent must be secured,
- appropriate insurance must be in place,
- journey details should be recorded.

A child should never be transported alone unless exceptional circumstances apply and appropriate approval has been obtained.

Gifts

Staff and volunteers should not:

- give expensive gifts,
- accept valuable gifts,
- lend or borrow money,
- exchange gifts that could create inappropriate relationships.

Small tokens of appreciation or awards approved by the charity may be acceptable.

Confidentiality

Confidential information must only be shared with those who need it to protect someone's welfare.

Confidentiality must never prevent the reporting of safeguarding concerns.

Where someone is at risk of harm, information will be shared with the appropriate agencies in accordance with safeguarding legislation and UK GDPR.



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Alcohol, Drugs and Smoking

Anyone representing Joybringers Charity must not:

- attend activities under the influence of alcohol or drugs,
- consume alcohol during activities involving children,
- smoke or vape in the presence of children or young people during charity activities.

Equality and Inclusion

Joybringers Charity values diversity and is committed to ensuring that everyone feels welcome, respected and included.

Discrimination, harassment, bullying or victimisation will not be tolerated.

Everyone has the right to participate in our activities free from prejudice or discrimination.

Duty to Report

Every trustee, employee and volunteer has a personal responsibility to report any safeguarding concern immediately.

Failure to report a safeguarding concern may itself be treated as a disciplinary matter.

12. Safer Recruitment

Joybringers Charity is committed to recruiting suitable people who share our commitment to safeguarding.

We recognise that safer recruitment is one of the most effective ways of protecting children, young people and adults at risk.

All recruitment decisions will place safeguarding at the centre of the process.



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Recruitment Principles

We will:

- recruit fairly and transparently,
- verify identity,
- obtain references where appropriate,
- carry out right to work checks,
- conduct DBS checks where required,
- assess suitability to work with children and adults at risk,
- provide safeguarding induction before individuals begin regulated activities.

Disclosure and Barring Service (DBS)

Enhanced DBS checks will normally be required for anyone undertaking regulated activity with children or adults at risk.

Where a DBS check is not legally required, a risk assessment will be undertaken before the individual begins volunteering or working.

DBS certificates may be reviewed periodically where appropriate.

Recruitment Checks

Depending on the role, recruitment checks may include:

- application form,
- interview,
- proof of identity,
- proof of address,
- right to work documentation,
- qualifications,
- employment history,
- professional references,
- DBS check,
- safeguarding declaration.



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Induction

Every new trustee, employee and volunteer will receive an induction covering:

- this Safeguarding Policy,
- Code of Conduct,
- reporting procedures,
- health and safety,
- equality and diversity,
- whistleblowing,
- confidentiality,
- GDPR.

No individual should work unsupervised with beneficiaries until appropriate induction has been completed.

Ongoing Monitoring

Joybringers Charity will continue to monitor the suitability of staff and volunteers throughout their time with the organisation.

Concerns about conduct or behaviour will be addressed promptly and may result in additional supervision, retraining, disciplinary action or referral to external agencies where appropriate.

13. Safeguarding Training

Our Commitment

Joybringers Charity recognises that safeguarding is most effective when everyone understands their responsibilities and has the knowledge and confidence to respond appropriately to concerns.

All trustees, employees and volunteers will receive safeguarding training appropriate to their role.

Safeguarding training forms part of our induction process and is refreshed regularly to ensure compliance with current legislation and best practice.



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Mandatory Training

The following safeguarding training is mandatory where appropriate to the role:

- Safeguarding Children
- Safeguarding Adults at Risk
- Recognising Signs of Abuse
- Reporting Safeguarding Concerns
- Professional Boundaries
- Equality, Diversity and Inclusion
- Prevent Awareness
- Online Safety
- GDPR and Confidentiality

Trustee Training

All trustees are expected to:

- Understand their safeguarding responsibilities.
- Read this Safeguarding Policy.
- Complete safeguarding awareness training.
- Promote a safeguarding culture across the organisation.

Staff Training

Employees will receive:

- Safeguarding induction before commencing their role.
- Refresher safeguarding training at least every two years.
- Additional role-specific training where appropriate.

Volunteer Training

Before working with beneficiaries, volunteers will receive training covering:

- Safeguarding awareness.
- The Code of Conduct.
- Reporting procedures.
- Professional boundaries.



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- Health and safety.
 - Equality and inclusion.

Designated Safeguarding Lead Training

The Designated Safeguarding Lead and Deputy DSL will undertake enhanced safeguarding training appropriate to their responsibilities and keep their knowledge up to date through continuing professional development.

Training Records

Joybringers Charity will maintain records of safeguarding training completed by trustees, staff and volunteers.

Training records will include:

- Name
- Training completed
- Date completed
- Expiry or review date
- Refresher requirements

14. Responding to Safeguarding Concerns

Every safeguarding concern must be taken seriously.

No trustee, employee or volunteer should ignore a concern or attempt to investigate it themselves.

The role of staff and volunteers is to recognise concerns, respond appropriately and report them promptly.

If Someone Makes a Disclosure

If a child, young person or adult at risk tells you something that raises a safeguarding concern:

DO

✓ Stay calm.



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-
- ✓ Listen carefully.
 - ✓ Allow the person to speak freely.
 - ✓ Reassure them that they have done the right thing by telling you.
 - ✓ Explain that you may need to share the information to keep them safe.
 - ✓ Record exactly what was said as soon as possible.
 - ✓ Report the concern immediately to the Designated Safeguarding Lead.

DO NOT

- ✗ Promise to keep it a secret.
- ✗ Ask leading questions.
- ✗ Interrupt unnecessarily.
- ✗ Investigate the allegation yourself.
- ✗ Contact the alleged perpetrator.
- ✗ Delay reporting the concern.

Immediate Danger

If someone is in immediate danger:

- Call **999** immediately.
- Take reasonable steps to protect the individual without putting yourself or others at risk.
- Inform the Designated Safeguarding Lead as soon as possible.

Recording Concerns

All safeguarding concerns must be recorded as soon as possible.

Records should include:



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- Date and time.
- Name of the individual.
- What was observed or disclosed.
- Exact words used where possible.
- Action taken.
- Name of the person making the report.

Records should be factual and avoid personal opinions or assumptions.

Confidentiality

Safeguarding information will be shared only with those who need to know in order to protect an individual from harm and in accordance with UK GDPR and relevant safeguarding legislation.

Confidentiality must never prevent appropriate safeguarding action.

15. Reporting Procedures

Our Approach

Joybringers Charity is committed to ensuring that all safeguarding concerns are reported promptly, handled appropriately and recorded accurately.

No concern is too small to report. If in doubt, staff and volunteers should always seek advice from the Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL).

Every concern will be treated seriously, fairly and confidentially.

Reporting Process

Step 1 – Recognise

A safeguarding concern may arise because:

- Someone tells you they are being harmed.
- You witness something concerning.
- You notice changes in behaviour or appearance.
- Someone else shares information with you.



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- You become concerned through online communication.

Step 2 – Respond

If someone makes a disclosure:

- Stay calm.
- Listen carefully.
- Do not interrupt unnecessarily.
- Reassure them they have done the right thing.
- Never promise to keep secrets.
- Explain that you may need to share the information to keep them safe.

Step 3 – Record

Write down:

- Date and time
- Person involved
- What happened
- What was said (using the person's own words where possible)
- Your observations
- Any action taken

Records must be factual and objective.

Step 4 – Report

Report the concern immediately to:

Designated Safeguarding Lead

or

Deputy Designated Safeguarding Lead if the DSL is unavailable.

Step 5 – Refer

The DSL will determine whether the concern should be referred to:



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- Children's Social Care
- Adult Social Care
- Northumbria Police
- Local Authority Designated Officer (LADO)
- Charity Commission (where appropriate)
- Other relevant agencies

Only the DSL (or Deputy DSL where appropriate) should normally make referrals on behalf of Joybringers Charity, unless there is an immediate risk of harm.

Emergency Situations

If someone is in immediate danger:

1. Call **999**.
2. Protect the individual where it is safe to do so.
3. Inform the DSL as soon as possible.
4. Complete a safeguarding record.

Emergency action must never be delayed while waiting for the DSL.

If the Concern Involves the DSL

If a safeguarding concern relates to the Designated Safeguarding Lead:

- Report the concern directly to the Chair of Trustees.
- If appropriate, contact Children's Social Care or the Police directly.

Confidentiality

Information will only be shared with people who need it to safeguard an individual.

Records will be:

- confidential,
- secure,
- accurate,
- retained in accordance with UK GDPR and our Data Protection Policy.



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What is an Allegation?

An allegation may arise where someone working or volunteering with Joybringers Charity is believed to have:

- harmed a child or adult at risk;
- committed a criminal offence against them;
- behaved in a way that indicates they may pose a risk to others;
- breached the charity's safeguarding standards.

Immediate Action

Where an allegation is received:

- The individual receiving the allegation must immediately inform the DSL.
- If the allegation concerns the DSL, it must be reported to the Chair of Trustees.
- No internal investigation should begin until advice has been sought from the appropriate statutory agency where required.

Referrals

Where appropriate, the DSL will seek advice from or refer the matter to:

- The Local Authority Designated Officer (LADO), where the allegation concerns a child.
- Adult Social Care, where an adult at risk is involved.
- Northumbria Police, where a criminal offence may have been committed.
- The Charity Commission, if the matter constitutes a serious incident.

Suspension

Suspension is not an automatic response to an allegation.

The Board of Trustees will consider, with appropriate advice, whether temporary suspension or alternative arrangements are necessary to protect beneficiaries and ensure a fair investigation.



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Confidentiality

Information relating to allegations will be handled sensitively and shared only with those who have a legitimate need to know.

The identities of all parties will be protected as far as possible while ensuring appropriate safeguarding action is taken.

Outcomes

Following investigation, outcomes may include:

- No further action.
- Additional safeguarding training.
- Changes to working practices.
- Disciplinary action.
- Termination of employment or volunteering.
- Referral to the Disclosure and Barring Service (DBS), where required by law.
- Referral to professional regulatory bodies, where applicable.

Learning and Improvement

Following any safeguarding incident or allegation, Joybringers Charity will review:

- what happened,
- whether policies were followed,
- lessons learned,
- improvements needed to reduce future risks.

The Board of Trustees will monitor implementation of any agreed actions.

17. Online Safety and Digital Safeguarding

Commitment

Joybringers Charity recognises that digital technology provides valuable opportunities for learning, communication and engagement. However, it also presents safeguarding risks.



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We are committed to ensuring that all online activities are delivered in a safe, respectful and secure environment.

This section applies to:

- Online training
- Virtual mentoring
- Microsoft Teams
- Zoom
- WhatsApp groups
- Social media
- Email
- Learning platforms
- Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools used during learning

Online Learning

When delivering online sessions:

- Participants should use their first name only where appropriate.
- Meeting links must only be shared with registered participants.
- Waiting rooms should be enabled where available.
- Sessions should be supervised by authorised staff or volunteers.
- Sessions involving children should not normally be delivered by a single adult acting alone.
- Participants should behave respectfully at all times.

Online Communication

Staff and volunteers must:

- Use official Joybringers email addresses whenever possible.
- Use approved communication platforms.
- Keep communication professional.
- Communicate only for legitimate programme purposes.

Staff and volunteers must not:

- Use personal social media accounts to communicate privately with children.
- Share inappropriate material.



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-
- Engage in online conversations that are unrelated to charity activities.
 - Request personal photographs from beneficiaries.

Artificial Intelligence (AI)

Joybringers Charity encourages responsible use of AI technologies for learning.

Participants should be taught to:

- Use AI ethically.
- Protect personal information.
- Verify AI-generated information.
- Avoid sharing confidential or personal data with AI systems.

Staff must supervise the use of AI where appropriate.

Cyber Safety

Joybringers Charity will take reasonable steps to protect digital information through:

- Strong passwords
- Multi-factor authentication where available
- Secure storage
- Restricted access to sensitive information
- Regular software updates

18. Photography, Video and Social Media

Joybringers Charity values celebrating achievements while protecting privacy and dignity.

Consent

Photographs or videos will only be taken and used where appropriate consent has been obtained.

Consent should clearly explain:

- Why images are being taken.
- How they will be used.



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- Where they may be published.
- How long they may be retained.

Individuals may withdraw consent at any time, where practicable.

Appropriate Use

Images should:

- Promote positive activities.
- Respect dignity.
- Avoid identifying vulnerable individuals unnecessarily.
- Never expose participants to risk.

Photographs should never be manipulated in a misleading manner.

Social Media

Joybringers Charity uses social media responsibly to:

- Promote activities.
- Celebrate achievements.
- Share opportunities.
- Encourage community engagement.

Comments that are abusive, discriminatory or threatening may be removed.

Safeguarding concerns must never be discussed publicly on social media.

19. Health, Safety and Risk Management

Safeguarding and health and safety work together to create safe environments.

Before activities begin, appropriate risk assessments will be completed where necessary.

This includes:

- Training sessions
- Community events
- Food bank activities



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- Educational visits
- Holiday programmes
- Outdoor activities
- Family events
- Volunteer activities

Risk assessments will consider:

- Venue safety
- Emergency arrangements
- Accessibility
- Medical needs
- Supervision ratios
- Safeguarding risks
- Weather conditions
- Transport arrangements

Food Bank Activities

Because Joybringers Charity operates a food bank, additional safeguards include:

- Safe manual handling.
- Food hygiene standards.
- Safe storage of food.
- Respectful treatment of beneficiaries.
- Confidential handling of personal information.

Volunteers should never make beneficiaries feel embarrassed or judged.

Educational Visits

Every visit should include:

- Written risk assessment.
- Emergency contacts.
- Appropriate supervision.
- First aid provision.
- Consent where required.



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20. Record Keeping, Confidentiality and Information Sharing

Accurate records are essential for safeguarding.

Joybringers Charity will maintain secure records of safeguarding concerns and actions taken.

Safeguarding Records

Records should include:

- Date
- Time
- People involved
- Nature of concern
- Actions taken
- Referrals made
- Outcome

Records must be factual and avoid speculation.

Storage

Safeguarding records will be:

- securely stored,
- password protected where electronic,
- accessible only to authorised individuals.

Information Sharing

Information will be shared only:

- to protect someone from harm,
- where required by law,
- with statutory agencies,
- with consent where appropriate.

The safety of the individual will always take priority over confidentiality where there is a risk of significant harm.



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Retention

Safeguarding records will be retained in accordance with legal requirements and Joybringers Charity's Data Protection Policy.

21. Whistleblowing

Joybringers Charity encourages an open culture where concerns can be raised without fear.

Anyone working with the charity who believes that:

- safeguarding procedures are not being followed,
- someone is behaving inappropriately,
- beneficiaries are being placed at risk,

has a responsibility to report those concerns.

No person will suffer disadvantage for raising genuine safeguarding concerns in good faith.

Concerns may be reported to:

- The Designated Safeguarding Lead.
- The Chair of Trustees.
- External authorities where appropriate.

22. Monitoring, Review and Continuous Improvement

The Board of Trustees is responsible for ensuring that safeguarding remains effective across the organisation.

This policy will be:

- Reviewed annually.
- Reviewed following any serious safeguarding incident.
- Updated following significant legislative or regulatory changes.
- Monitored through regular trustee oversight.

The charity is committed to learning from experience and continually improving safeguarding practice.



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Version History

Version	Date	Summary of Changes	Approved By
1.0	April 2025	Initial policy	Board of Trustees
2.0	July 2026	Comprehensive review aligned with current UK safeguarding legislation and Charity Commission guidance	Board of Trustees

23. Key Safeguarding Contacts

Internal Contacts

Designated Safeguarding Lead

Name: Esele Okosun

Email: Esele.Okosun@joybringerscharity.org

Telephone: +44 7500 010317

Deputy Designated Safeguarding Lead

Name: John Porlycarp

Email: john.porlycarp@joybringerscharity.org

Telephone: +44 7500 010317

External Contacts

Emergency Services

Emergency: **999**

Non-emergency Police: **101**



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North Tyneside Children's Social Care

Telephone: **0345 200 0109**

North Tyneside Adult Social Care

Telephone: **0345 200 0101**

North Tyneside Multi-Agency Safeguarding Hub (MASH)

Telephone: **0345 200 0109**

NSPCC Helpline

0808 800 5000

Childline

0800 1111

If Joybringers expands beyond North Tyneside or delivers activities elsewhere, the relevant local safeguarding contacts should also be included for those areas.

Appendices

The appendices should be practical resources that staff and volunteers can use:



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Appendix A – Safeguarding Concern Report Form

A standard form for recording concerns, including dates, observations, actions taken and referrals.

Appendix B – Body Map

A simple body outline for recording visible injuries (to be completed only by trained personnel where appropriate).

Appendix C – Incident Log

A template for recording safeguarding incidents, follow-up actions and outcomes.

Appendix D – Safeguarding Flowchart

A one-page visual guide showing the steps from recognising a concern to reporting and referral.

Appendix E – Safeguarding Checklist

A checklist for events and programmes covering supervision, consent, risk assessments, first aid, emergency contacts and venue safety.

Appendix F – Training Record Template

A register for tracking safeguarding training completed by trustees, staff and volunteers.